



ACTUARY

JOB DESCRIPTION

Actuaries assess the probability of a particular event occurring and then calculate the possible financial risks to a company. Many actuaries work for insurance companies, at which they calculate the likelihood of a loss, such as the chances of a ship sinking at sea, and set the amount to be paid by the ship's owners. Others work in banks, monitoring the levels of risk when buying and selling investments.



SALARY

Actuary ★★★★★

Senior director ★★★★★

INDUSTRY PROFILE

Jobs available worldwide, although competition for places is strong • Opportunities within a wide range of businesses and organizations • High salary

AT A GLANCE



YOUR INTERESTS Mathematics • Statistics • Economics • Risk management • Business studies • Information Technology (IT) • Science



ENTRY QUALIFICATIONS A degree in a numerate subject—such as mathematics, statistics, or actuarial science—is required.



LIFESTYLE Actuaries usually work regular hours, although evening or weekend working may be required to meet deadlines.



LOCATION Actuarial work is office-based and firms are mostly found in large cities. Business travel to visit clients is occasionally required.



THE REALITIES This mathematical, intellectually challenging field requires a determined mindset. The exams to achieve accreditation can be grueling.

▼ RELATED CAREERS

► **INVESTMENT ANALYST** *see pp. 100–101*

► **ACCOUNTANT** *see pp. 102–103*

► **AUDITOR** Checks the financial accounts of companies and organizations to ensure that they are accurate and follow legal guidelines. Auditors also assess the health of clients' businesses and advise on ways to avoid risk.

► **INSURANCE UNDERWRITER** Works for an insurance company assessing applications for the insurance cover of individuals and businesses. Underwriters decide if insurance cover should be given and set the terms and price of the insurance policy.

In 2013, actuary was rated the best job in the country based on salary, prospects, stress levels, and work environment.